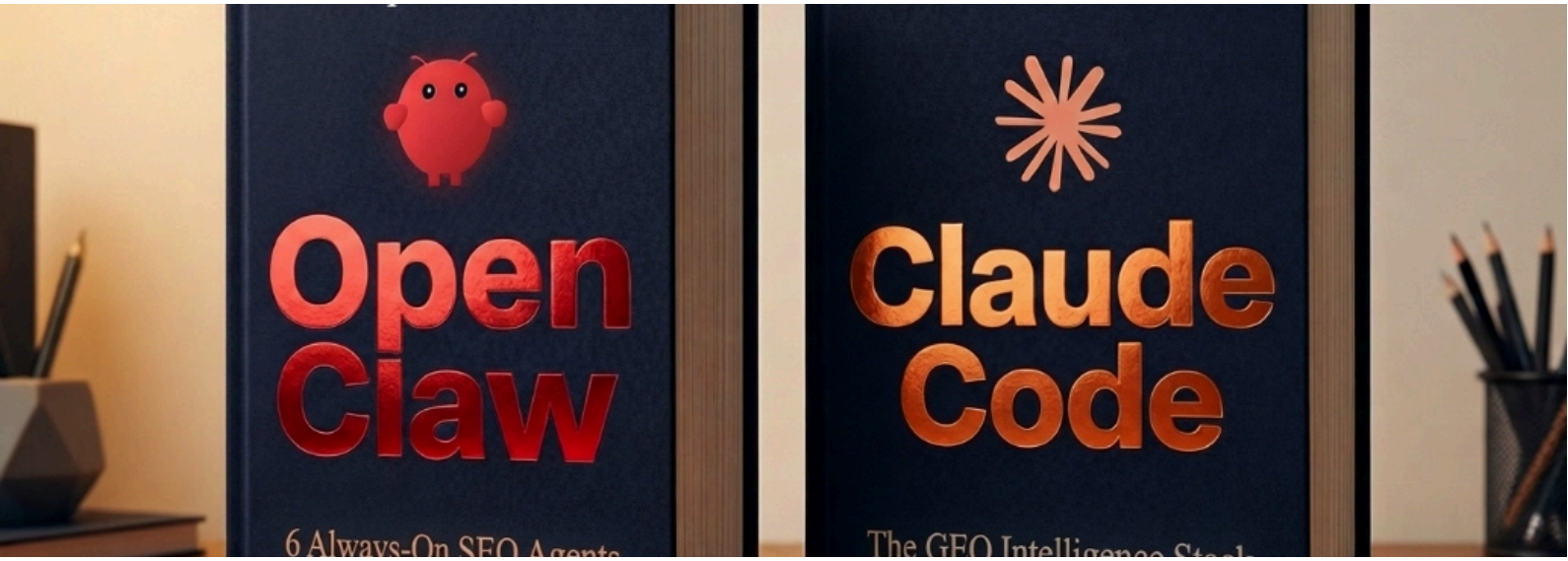

How to Deploy 6 Always-On Agents for SEO & GEO on a $5 VPS Using OpenClaw + Claude

The SEO Shakeout

The Foundation — OpenClaw on a VPS

The 6 Bots — What They Do

The Technical Build — SOUL.md & HEARTBEAT.md

The Monthly Invoice

The Real-World Proof

Your Move

The SEO Shakeout

Search is dead. At least the old version.

Welcome to GEO. Generative Engine Optimization.

Google AI Overviews. ChatGPT. Perplexity. Gemini.

They answer questions right on the screen.

No clicks. No blue links.

If your brand is not cited in those AI answers, you are invisible.

The market has split into 3 tiers for 2026.

Tier 1: The Legacy Agency

These are the dinosaurs.

They do manual site audits. They send monthly PDF reports.

They build backlinks like it is 2019.

They charge $5,000 to $10,000 a month.

They bill for manual work that AI does in 2 hours.

These agencies are dying.

Tier 2: The DIY Operator

You can build an AI system yourself.

The tech is out there.

But here is the reality.

It takes 40 to 120 hours to set up.

It needs maintenance every single month.

Most business owners do not know Linux, servers, or APIs.

You make one mistake in the config file.

Your system goes silent for weeks. You lose ground.

Tier 3: The AI-Native Agency

This is the future.

These agencies deploy agent systems for you.

They already built the config files.

They tested the edge cases.

They know which subreddits matter.

They know which queries to track.

What takes a DIY operator 120 hours, they do in a week.

The Reality Check

This guide gives you the full blueprint.

You can take this and build it.

But knowing the architecture is easy.

Running 6 production agents 24/7 without breaking is hard.

Closing that gap is why professionals earn their fee.

The Cost Breakdown

Method	Monthly Cost	Time Cost	Result
Legacy Agency	$7,500 - $18,500	None	Outdated tactics
DIY Operator	$24	40 - 120 hours	High risk of failure
AI-Native Agency	$2,000 - $5,000	None	24/7 GEO dominance

The Foundation — OpenClaw on a VPS

You need a base of operations.

We use OpenClaw.

It is an open-source AI agent framework.

It runs on your own server.

It uses a heartbeat timer to wake up on a schedule.

It connects to Claude or any big language model.

Think of it as systemd for AI agents.

What You Need

- A cheap VPS. $5 to $10 a month.
- OpenClaw. It is free.
- Anthropic API key. Pay-as-you-go. Plan for $15 a month.
- A Telegram bot. It is free.

Step 1: Spin Up the Server

Rent a VPS.

Hetzner is $4.50. Contabo is $5. DigitalOcean is $6.

You need 2GB of RAM and 1 CPU.

Install Ubuntu 24.04.

Step 2: Install OpenClaw

Log into your server as root.

Run this command:

```
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```

Step 3: Create the Workspace

Make a folder for your agents.

```
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Step 4: Build the Structure

Your workspace needs specific folders.

- `workspace/` holds SOUL.md and HEARTBEAT.md.
- `knowledge-base/` holds your brand rules.
- `logs/` tracks what happens.
- `data/` stores the output.

Step 5: Configure the Engine

You need an `openclaw.json` file.

Put it in your root folder.

```
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```

Step 6: The Settings That Matter

Do not skip these.

`showOk`: Set this to true. If you leave it out, the bot drops silent errors. You will never know it failed.

`directPolicy`: Set this to allow. You need version 2026.2.25 or higher. It lets the bot write files.

`heartbeat`: Set it to "every 2 hours". This keeps the system moving.

Step 7: Connect Telegram

Open Telegram. Search for @BotFather.

Type `/newbot`. Follow the steps.

Copy the token.

Search for @userinfobot. Get your chat ID.

Put both into your JSON config.

Step 8: Start the Engine

Turn it on.

```
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```

Keep it running when you log out.

```
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```

The 6 Bots — What They Do

You are building a team.

Six bots. Working non-stop.

Here is what they do.

Bot 1: The Site Watchdog

This bot checks your technical health.

It crawls your sitemap every 2 hours.

It checks HTTP status codes. It checks page speed.

It reads meta tags and schema markup.

It checks your SSL certificate and mobile layout.

It compares the new scan to the last scan.

If something breaks, it sends an alert.

Why it matters: AI engines hate broken sites.

If your schema is wrong, Perplexity ignores you.

Bot 2: The Reddit Scout

This bot hunts for buyers.

It watches your target subreddits.

It looks for specific phrases.

"Best software for X." "Recommend a Y." "Alternative to Z."

It reads the threads. It drafts a real, helpful response.

It queues the draft for your approval.

This is not spam. It is value.

Why it matters: AI engines trust Reddit.

Domains with Reddit mentions get cited 4x more by AI.

Bot 3: The AI Citation Tracker

This bot tracks your brand visibility.

It searches ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google AI Overviews.

It runs your target keywords on a schedule.

It checks if you are mentioned.

It checks how you are described.

It logs who else got cited. It tracks the sources.

It builds a GEO scorecard over time.

Why it matters: You cannot fix what you do not track.

Brands that ignore AI visibility will lose market share.

Bot 4: The X Engagement Agent

This bot builds authority on social media.

It searches X for industry keywords.

It looks for competitor mentions and pain points.

It finds high-value threads.

It drafts contextual replies.

It tracks trending topics to give you content ideas.

Why it matters: Social signals matter.

AI engines look at social reach to judge brand authority.

Bot 5: The Content Gap Hunter

This bot reverse-engineers the AI.

It looks at the sources AI engines cite.

It compares those sources to your website.

It finds the gaps.

"You have no content on Topic A. Competitor B is getting all the AI traffic for it."

It scores the gaps by opportunity.

Why it matters: Content is ammo.

Brands that publish the right content get 200x faster visibility gains.

Bot 6: The Review & Local SEO Sentinel

This bot guards your reputation.

It checks Google, Yelp, and local directories.

It looks for new reviews.

It drafts replies.

A thank you for good reviews. A professional fix for bad ones.

It checks your Name, Address, and Phone number across the web.

Why it matters: AI engines read reviews for local search.

One bad review with no reply tanks your AI ranking.

The Technical Build — SOUL.md & HEARTBEAT.md

The system needs rules.

You give it rules with two files.

SOUL.md tells the bots who they are.

HEARTBEAT.md tells them what to do and when.

The Directory Structure

Build the folders first.

```
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```

You need seed files to start.

- `urls.txt`: Put your sitemap and core pages here.
- `queries.txt`: Put your target keywords here.
- `our-content.json`: List your current blog posts here.

The Combined SOUL.md

This file lives in your workspace folder.

It has general rules for all bots.

It has specific rules for each bot.

```
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```

The Combined HEARTBEAT.md

This file drives the schedule.

It uses priority tiers.

OpenClaw wakes up, reads this, and does the work.

```
> Loading Plain Text code...
```

Deploy these files.

Start the engine.

Watch your phone.

The war room is open.

The Monthly Invoice

Let us look at the math.

A legacy agency charges a premium for manual labor.

An AI agent charges fractions of a cent per token.

It is not a fair fight.

Function	Agency Cost	Agent Cost
Technical SEO Monitoring	$500 - $1,500/mo	~$2/mo
Reddit Engagement	$2,000 - $4,000/mo	~$3/mo
AI Citation Tracking	$1,000 - $3,000/mo	~$4/mo
X/Social Engagement	$1,500 - $3,000/mo	~$3/mo
Content Strategy	$2,000 - $5,000/mo	~$5/mo
Reputation Management	$500 - $2,000/mo	~$2/mo
TOTAL	**$7,500 - $18,500/mo**	**~$19/mo**

Add a $5 VPS to that $19 API cost.

Your total hard cost is $24 a month.

But cost is not the main point.

Speed is the point.

An agency sends a PDF report on the 15th of the month.

They tell you what broke two weeks ago.

These agents catch problems in two hours.

Coverage is the point.

No human monitors Reddit, X, Google, Perplexity, and Yelp at the same time.

Six agents can.

They do not sleep.

They do not miss a brand mention buried in a niche subreddit.

Time for a reality check.

That $24 price tag assumes zero labor cost.

It assumes you do the work.

You set up the server.

You build the text files.

You tune the prompts when the output looks bad.

You fix the bugs when an API breaks.

Add your own hourly rate to the math.

The numbers change fast.

This is why AI-native agencies exist.

They absorb the tech headaches.

They maintain the code.

You get the massive coverage without the daily grind.

The Real-World Proof

This architecture is not a theory.

It runs in production right now.

Real businesses use this exact setup to scale.

The OpenClaw framework does much more than SEO.

It handles inbound lead response.

It researches prospects and updates CRMs.

It writes personal emails and tracks the follow-up cadence.

All from a $5 VPS.

Picture a sales bot.

It watches a Slack channel for new lead signals.

It scrapes the company website and the founder profile.

It writes a custom pitch.

It logs the data.

It reports back via Telegram.

The architecture is identical to your SEO War Room.

The server is the same.

The gateway is the same.

The only difference is the text file.

You do not build a new software product for every task.

You just write a new SOUL.md.

That is the real power here.

One server can run many projects at the same time.

Your SEO bots.

Your lead response bots.

Your content bots.

All living on one $5 machine.

They stay awake.

The heartbeat file runs every two hours on a rigid schedule.

The gateway survives server reboots.

Linger mode keeps everything alive if your SSH connection drops.

It is bulletproof.

You set it up once.

It runs until you tell it to stop.

Your Move

You have the blueprint.

You have the configs and the architecture.

Now you have to choose.

Here are your three paths forward.

Option 1: Build It Yourself (DIY)

Open your terminal.

Spin up a VPS.

Install OpenClaw.

Paste the SOUL.md and HEARTBEAT.md files from this guide.

Start the gateway.

If you know your way around a command line, you can be live in an hour.

The hard cost is $24 a month.

The hidden cost is your time.

Option 2: Join a Community

Do not build in the dark.

Learn alongside other operators.

Share your configs and steal theirs.

Get help when your heartbeat goes silent at 3am.

The AI agent space is growing fast.

Find a group of builders that fits your style.

Option 3: Hire an AI-Native Agency

You want these six bots running by next week.

You do not want to touch a terminal.

Your time is worth more than debugging code.

An AI-native agency handles the entire build.

They deploy the system.

They tune the configs.

They monitor the output and do the routine maintenance.

You get total brand coverage.

They absorb the complexity.

This is the fastest path to GEO dominance.

The agents are waiting.

The code is ready.